

● DESIGN & PRODUCT BRIEF

Admin Panel

Fix List & Redesign Plan

A plain-English walkthrough of everything that needs improvement in the NOFFELO admin dashboard — what's broken, why it matters, and exactly what to build instead.

13 ISSUES FOUND	4 PRIORITY LEVELS	4wk ROADMAP
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Prepared June 2026 · For Developer Handoff

Confidential — Internal Use Only

OVERVIEW

All 13 Issues at a Glance

Every issue found in the current admin panel, sorted by priority. Critical issues need to be fixed before anything else — they directly cause missed orders and lost information.

#	ISSUE DESCRIPTION	AREA	PRIORITY
1	No live alerts — admins miss new orders without manually clicking Refresh	Real-time	Critical
2	Success/error message disappears the moment you do another action	Feedback	Critical
3	New orders and completed orders look visually identical — no urgency signal	Status Colors	High
4	Metric cards sit in a broken 4+2 layout and show no urgency when pending	Layout	High
5	Add Menu Item form is permanently open, pushing the item list far down	Layout	High
6	Sidebar has no active highlight and no pending-count badges on nav links	Navigation	High
7	Tables cannot be sorted by date, guest count, or order total	Filters	Medium
8	Orders table has no pagination — 200+ rows will crash performance	Scalability	Medium
9	Status history line is a long, hard-to-scan sentence with full timestamps	Typography	Medium
10	Delete confirmation looks like a normal button — easy to miss or misclick	Safety	Medium
11	On mobile, sidebar becomes a full-height block before any content shows	Mobile	Low
12	Empty tables still show column headers — looks like a loading error	Empty States	Low
13	Add Item form has 10+ flat fields with no grouping — all feel equal weight	Forms	Low



Critical (Fix First)

2 issues that directly cause missed orders and confusing feedback. Must be resolved before anything else.



High Priority (Week 1)

4 structural problems that slow down the admin every single day. Biggest daily impact per dev hour.



Medium & Low (Week 2–4)

7 quality improvements that matter more as the business grows. No blockers today, painful next month.

CHAPTER 01

Critical Issues — Fix These First

2 Issues

These two issues directly cause missed orders and confusing feedback for the admin. They must be resolved before anything else is touched.

1

No live alerts — admins don't know when a new order arrives

Critical

THE PROBLEM The dashboard only updates when you manually click "Refresh." If you don't click it, you have no idea a new order or reservation came in. In a live cafe, this can mean a table waits 10–15 minutes before the kitchen even knows about the order.	WHY IT HURTS Customers wait longer than they should. Kitchen staff get behind. Frustrated guests complain. The entire purpose of a live admin panel is to react fast — right now it only reacts when someone remembers to click Refresh.	THE FIX • Every 60 seconds, silently check for new orders in the background — no page reload • If new orders arrive, show a green badge on the Orders sidebar link: "Orders • 3" • Show "Updated 28s ago" near the Refresh button so admin trusts the data is fresh • No visual disruption — just quiet counts updating
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WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

Sidebar shows "Orders • 3" with a green dot when 3 new orders came in. Admin sees it immediately without touching anything. Header shows "Updated 28s ago" so they know data is fresh.

2

Success/error message disappears the moment you do another action

Critical

THE PROBLEM There is one single notification bar at the top of the page. When you confirm a reservation it shows "Reservation updated." But the moment you change an order's status, it replaces the message. You never see both — the first one is gone forever.	WHY IT HURTS Admins doing quick back-to-back updates during busy hours lose confidence: "Did that reservation actually get confirmed?" They end up refreshing the whole page to double-check — wasting precious time during a rush.	THE FIX • Replace the single bar with a toast stack in the top-right corner • Each action gets its own toast — they stack vertically, never overwrite • Each toast disappears automatically after 4 seconds, or tap X to dismiss early • Green toasts for success, red for errors — up to 3 visible at once
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WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

Top-right shows two stacked cards: ✓ **"Reservation confirmed"** and below it ✓ **"Order updated."** Both visible. Both fade after 4 seconds. Admin can trust every action was recorded.

CHAPTER 02

High Priority — Fix in Week 1

4 Issues

3 New orders and completed orders look visually identical

High

THE PROBLEM

Every row in the orders and reservations tables looks the same — same background, same text color. A "new" order that needs immediate action looks identical to a "completed" one from yesterday.

WHY IT HURTS

Admin must read every row's status dropdown to find what needs attention. With 30+ rows, this takes real effort. The eyes have no visual anchor to jump to.

THE FIX

- **New rows:** amber left-border strip + very faint amber background
- **Completed/cancelled rows:** dimmed to 70% opacity — they visually recede
- No dropdown or logic changes — purely CSS visual treatment

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

Admin opens Orders — immediately sees 3 rows with a golden left stripe. Those are the new ones. The rest are lighter, clearly "done." Zero reading needed to find what requires action.

4 Metric cards sit in a broken grid with no urgency when items are pending

High

THE PROBLEM

6 metric cards use a 4-column layout — giving 4 cards on row 1 and 2 wide orphaned cards on row 2. Also, "New requests: 3" and "Total reservations: 47" look exactly the same.

WHY IT HURTS

The top of the dashboard is the first thing seen every shift. Right now it gives no signal about what needs attention today. Just numbers that all feel equal weight.

THE FIX

- Switch to a 3-column grid — two clean rows of 3 cards
- When "New orders" or "New requests" > 0: amber left border, amber number
- When zero: those cards look completely normal — no alarm state

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

6 cards in a clean 3×2 grid. "New orders: 4" has a golden border and colored number. "Available items: 23" looks normal. Admin knows in one glance what needs handling today.

5 Add Menu Item form is always visible, even when just browsing

High

THE PROBLEM

The 10-field "Add Item" form sits permanently at the top of the Menu section. Every time you scroll there, this giant form takes up 200px of space

WHY IT HURTS

Pushes the actual item list far down the page. When editing an existing item, you scroll past the add-form to reach

THE FIX

- Add a small "+ Add Item" button in the section header
- Form is collapsed by default — only appears when that button is clicked

even when you're just browsing or editing existing items.

the list. It's visual clutter 95% of the time.

- Successfully adding an item collapses the form automatically

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

Menu section opens showing the search bar and item list immediately. A compact **" + Add Item "** button sits in the header. Click it → form slides open. Close it → item list is right there.

6

Sidebar nav has no active highlight and no count badges

High

THE PROBLEM

All four sidebar links always look identical regardless of which section you're viewing. There's also nothing to tell you "3 new things are in Orders" without scrolling down to check manually.

WHY IT HURTS

Admin loses spatial orientation on this long-scrolling page. More importantly, they must actively visit each section to discover if there's new activity — the sidebar should do that job for them.

THE FIX

- As you scroll, the active sidebar link gets a green highlight automatically
- If Orders has 3 pending items: sidebar shows **"Orders ③"**
- Same for Reservations with pending count

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

Admin glances at sidebar: **"Reservations"** is highlighted (currently in that section), **"Orders"** shows a green **4** badge. Without scrolling anywhere, they know exactly where action is needed.

CHAPTER 03

Medium Priority — Fix in Week 2

4 Issues

7

Tables cannot be sorted — you can't find newest or biggest orders

Medium

THE PROBLEM

You can filter by status and search by name, but you cannot sort by anything — not by date, not by guest count, not by order total. Rows appear in whatever random order the server sends.

WHY IT HURTS

Most common workflow: "Show me today's newest reservations first." Or: "Which order is the largest?" Both impossible. Admin must mentally scan every row.

THE FIX

- Clickable column headers — once for ascending, again for descending
- Small ↑ or ↓ arrow shows current sort direction
- Works alongside existing search and status filter
- No server change — sorting happens on already-loaded data

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

Click "Visit" column header → reservations sort newest first, ↓ arrow appears. Click again → oldest first. Works on top of any active search filter.

8

Orders table has no pagination — will break with high volume

Medium

THE PROBLEM

Reservations show 10 per page with Previous/Next navigation. Orders show every single order in one endless list. A busy weekend means 100+ rows on one page.

WHY IT HURTS

Browser slows down rendering hundreds of rows. Scrolling becomes painful. The page feels broken. It's also inconsistent — Reservations are paginated, Orders are not.

THE FIX

- Apply the exact same 10-per-page pagination from Reservations to Orders
- Same Previous/Next buttons, same "Page 1 of 5" counter
- This is essentially a copy-paste job — the logic already exists

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

Orders shows 10 rows. Bottom-right shows "Page 1 of 8" with < > buttons. Fast, clean, consistent with Reservations.

9

Status history text is a long sentence — hard to scan at speed

Medium

THE PROBLEM

Below each status dropdown, there's text like: "Last: new to confirmed by Admin, 6/5/2026, 11:30:00 AM" — a full

WHY IT HURTS

Tables should be fast to scan. Long strings force you to read instead of glance. The full date + seconds is noise

THE FIX

- Shorten to: " → confirmed · 2h ago"
- Hover over it to see full detail in a tooltip: "by Admin on Jun 5, 11:30

sentence crammed into a small table cell, with seconds in the timestamp.

— all you need is "how long ago." The sentence structure adds zero value.

- AM"
- Relative time (2h ago, 3d ago) is faster to understand than absolute dates

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

Below the status dropdown: a small muted line reading "→ **confirmed · 2h ago**". Hover over it: tooltip shows *"Changed by Admin on Jun 5, 2026 at 11:30 AM."* Clean and informative.

10

Delete confirmation looks like a normal button — dangerously easy to miss

Medium

THE PROBLEM

When you click the trash icon on a menu item, a "Confirm delete" button appears inline in the same actions row — same size, same location as normal buttons. On mobile it stretches full-width.

WHY IT HURTS

Deleting a menu item is permanent. Confirmation should feel like a moment of pause — visually distinct from normal actions. Right now it blends in. A rushed admin can accidentally confirm a delete.

THE FIX

- When delete is clicked, a full-width red banner slides open inside the menu item row
- Clearly states the item name: *"Delete 'Matcha Latte'? This cannot be undone."*
- Two distinct buttons: red **"Delete permanently"** and grey **"Cancel"**
- Rest of row fades out — visually separated from normal state

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

A red-tinted banner slides into the row: **"Delete 'Matcha Latte'? This cannot be undone."** Hard to miss, hard to accidentally confirm, consequences clearly stated.

CHAPTER 04

Low Priority — Polish in Week 3–4

3 Issues

11 On mobile, the sidebar takes over the top of the screen before any content

Low

THE PROBLEM

On a phone, the sidebar (logo + 4 nav links + logout) renders as a tall vertical block. You must scroll past all of it before seeing the actual dashboard content.

WHY IT HURTS

Admins checking orders during a busy shift on their phone waste time scrolling past navigation every single visit. Every major mobile admin app (Shopify, Square) has solved this.

THE FIX

- On mobile: sidebar becomes a **bottom tab bar** pinned to the screen bottom
- Slim top strip shows only logo + logout icon
- Content starts immediately below — no nav scrolling

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

Phone shows: slim top bar → content fills the screen → 4 tab icons pinned at the bottom. Active tab highlighted in green. Identical to how Shopify's mobile admin works.

12 Empty tables still render column headers — looks like a broken state

Low

THE PROBLEM

When a search returns no results, the table still renders with its column headers (Guest, Visit, Contact, Status) — and then nothing below them. Then a plain text "No reservations match this view." appears below.

WHY IT HURTS

A table with headers but no rows looks like data failed to load. Every admin's instinct is to refresh, even when the result is intentionally empty.

THE FIX

- When results are zero: hide the table entirely
- Show a centered empty state with a relevant icon and helpful message
- If search is active: "No orders match your search. Try clearing the filter."

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

Search with no results: a centered box with a subtle icon and **"No orders match 'oat latte'."** Clean, intentional — not a broken-looking empty table.

13 Add Item form has 10+ flat fields — required and optional look the same

Low

THE PROBLEM

All fields — name, category, price, image URL, alt text, tags, sort order, checkboxes — sit in a flat 4-column grid. Required fields look identical to rarely-touched optional ones.

WHY IT HURTS

"Sort order" (touched maybe twice a year) competes visually with "Name" (filled every time you add an item). The form feels heavier than it needs to be.

THE FIX

- Split into two groups: **"Core details"** (name, category, price, description) and **"Optional"** (image, tags, sort order, flags)

- A subtle divider + label separates the two groups
- Required fields get a small asterisk marker

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER THE FIX

Form shows "Core details" (4 fields admin always fills) → divider → "Optional extras" (image, tags, sort order). Faster to complete. Important fields at top, nice-to-haves below.

CHAPTER 05

4-Week Build Roadmap

Developer Handoff

Each week is a self-contained sprint. Share this directly with your developer — they can start without any additional briefing beyond what is written on each card.

Week 1 — Quick Wins

4 Changes

- **Issue #2** — Replace single notice bar with a toast notification stack (top-right, 4-second auto-dismiss)
- **Issue #3** — Color-code "new" rows with amber left border; dim completed/cancelled rows
- **Issue #4** — Fix metric grid from 4-column to 3-column; add urgency coloring when pending count > 0
- **Issue #5** — Collapse "Add Item" form behind a toggle button in the section header

Biggest daily UX lift per developer hour — all CSS + minor JSX

Week 2 — Navigation & Scale

4 Changes

- **Issue #6** — Add sidebar active state (IntersectionObserver) + pending count badges on nav links
- **Issue #7** — Sortable column headers on Reservations and Orders tables (client-side, no API change)
- **Issue #8** — Pagination for Orders table — copy exact logic from Reservations section
- **Issue #10** — Delete confirmation as a full-width red banner overlay inside the row

Navigation clarity + safety as data volume grows over time

Week 3 — Live Awareness

3 Changes

- **Issue #1** — 60-second background polling; green badge on sidebar when new orders arrive; "Updated Xs ago" timestamp near Refresh
- **Issue #9** — Shorten status history to "→ confirmed · 2h ago" with hover tooltip for full detail
- Bonus: Add shimmer skeleton rows while data is loading instead of the single top-level spinner

Real-time cafe operations — fewer missed orders during rush hours

Week 4 — Polish & Mobile

3 Changes

- **Issue #11** — Mobile bottom tab bar navigation; slim top strip for logo + logout only
- **Issue #12** — Friendly empty states with icon and contextual message — hide table headers when results are zero
- **Issue #13** — Group Add Item form into "Core details" and "Optional" sections with visual divider

Professional finish — works properly on phones and tablets



Note for the Developer

Every fix in this document works within the existing codebase. **No new libraries, no backend changes, no database updates required.** All changes are contained in **AdminDashboard.jsx** and **styles.css**. The existing color system (moss green, amber/brass, cream, ink) is already defined as CSS variables and must be reused throughout — do not introduce new colors. All existing functionality — status updates, form submissions, search, filtering, pagination — stays 100% intact. These are improvements layered on top of what already works.